THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Two committees, two down days

Both of Elon Musk's public companies now describe the review of a possible combination in their quarterly reports. "The Tesla board of directors has formed a special committee (the 'Special Committee') comprising disinterested directors to explore deepening Tesla's relationship with SpaceX, which could be through certain arrangements including without limitation a business combination," Tesla's 10-Q says. SpaceX's 10-Q, filed at 4:03 p.m. EDT Thursday, says its board "has formed a special committee to evaluate a potential combination between SpaceX and Tesla, Inc.," and that "No determination by our special committee has been made."

Both stocks fell on Thursday. Tesla lost 3.08% to $374.58 after cutting its 2026 capital spending forecast to about $20 billion, Reuters reported, and SpaceX dropped 9.14% to $144.75 as the first tranche of locked-up shares became eligible for sale, according to The Motley Fool and the prospectus. A combination could create a company worth about $3.5 trillion, Reuters said.

I · TESLA

Megapacks "as much as possible"

Musk answered the sold-out question; Robotaxi hours grew in Austin, and Cybertruck was cancelled for Australia.

−3.08%
Tesla's Thursday move, to $374.58

~$20B
2026 capital spending forecast, down from more than $25 billion

1 a.m.
new closing hour for Robotaxi in Austin

"We are increasing production of Megapacks as much as possible," Musk replied at 2:13 p.m. EDT Thursday to a post quoting his remark on Wednesday's call that Tesla is "almost sold out of all Megapacks for 2027." The spending cut was "raising concerns among investors counting on heavy investment for Elon Musk's AI and robotics vision," Reuters wrote. "The risk is Tesla now enters a period of limbo while investors await news on a potential combination with SpaceX," AJ Bell's Russ Mould told the agency.



A Tesla Model Y charges on Odeonsplatz in Munich, Germany, on September 4, 2023.
PHOTO: AUHAIDHAUSEN / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0

Tesla expanded its Robotaxi service area in Austin to include the area around the city's Formula 1 circuit ahead of race weekend, and the service "now runs until 1 AM (from 12 AM before)," Sawyer Merritt posted at 1:59 a.m. EDT Friday. On Wednesday's call, AI software head Ashok Elluswamy said hours would go to "pretty soon 2:00 a.m.," TeslaNorth reported.

QUICK HIT

Not coming. "After careful consideration, plans to produce Cybertruck for Australia and New Zealand have been discontinued," Tesla Australia told reservation holders, Drive reported. Deposits will be refunded, and holders who buy a Model 3 or Model Y get a year of FSD (Supervised).

In Texas, Fort Bend County commissioners approved incentives on Thursday for Tesla's proposed $10.1 billion solar cell plant, which would create about 9,700 direct jobs if the site is chosen, Community Impact reported.

II · SPACEX & STARLINK

"Way too high"

Musk disputed a NASA panel's estimate of 22 refueling launches for a Starship Moon landing.

The latest estimate for refuelings needed to support a Starship landing on the Moon is "around 22" launches, Charlie Precourt said at Thursday's meeting of NASA's Aerospace Safety Advisory Panel, Ars Technica's Eric Berger posted. "That's way too high. Actual number will be more like 6 to 8," Musk replied at 5:12 p.m. EDT (Ars Technica). NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman and other agency leaders will discuss efforts to accelerate the Artemis campaign at a 2:00 p.m. EDT teleconference today, a NASA advisory says.



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024. Flight 15 is now expected in mid-November.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

SpaceX is seeking access to at least 80,000 U.S. cell sites for a wireless network and is in talks with Crown Castle, Bloomberg News reported, in deals that could reach into the billions of dollars. On Tuesday's earnings call, Musk said the effort "will pave the way for Starlink Mobile to become a major mobile carrier in the US," Bloomberg noted. The 10-Q counts 13.6 million Starlink consumer subscribers at September 30, up from 7.2 million a year earlier.

QUICK HIT

Third scrub. SpaceX stood down from Starlink 15-15 at Vandenberg in the final minute on Thursday because of weather, and said the next opportunity is no earlier than Friday; the window opens at 5:30 p.m. EDT, according to Spaceflight Now.

III · X & GROK

Grok Bot on the phone

The AI agent can now use a phone's calendar, reminders and contacts, and Musk kept recommending it.

"Grok Bot now integrates with your phone apps," Musk posted at 9:34 p.m. EDT Thursday, quoting the product's announcement: "Grok Bot can now use Calendar, Reminders, Contacts, and more apps on your phone. Rolling out now on iOS and Android." A minute later he wrote "It's that easy" over a user's post about ordering two watches for his children with a single text.

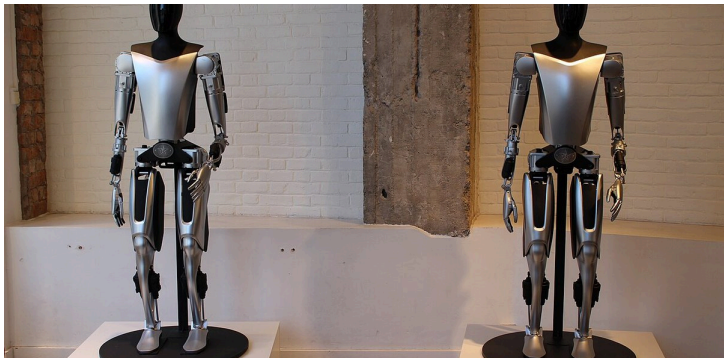
"Grok @Bot is an incredible life & business manager. Can help you with almost anything! Like having a genius employee," he posted at 1:42 a.m. Friday. Eight minutes later he added "Try Grok @Bot" over a thread of examples, from "getting money back on medical bills" to "managing family schedules."

Earlier Thursday, at 2:14 p.m., he replied "True" to a post saying most people use Grok Bot like a chatbot, "But it has its own computer and keeps working while you're away!"

"A resource allocation problem"

On Walter Isaacson's The Builders podcast, released October 20 and recorded August 6, Musk talked about wealth.

"There's a limit to what any single human can consume. You hit that saturation point pretty fast," Musk told his biographer, Moneycontrol reported. Having $10 billion instead of $1 billion does not make a person ten times happier, he argued, describing the management of such wealth as a "resource allocation problem." Forbes estimated his net worth at $1.013 trillion on October 21, after gains in Tesla and SpaceX shares, the report said.



Two Tesla Optimus humanoid robots on display in Stockholm on May 13, 2024.

PHOTO: ULF KLINGSTRÖM / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Musk also explained that his fortune is tied to voting control of Tesla and SpaceX, and said most of his wealth will go toward multiplanetary efforts later, according to Moneycontrol, which noted that none of the 12 tranches of the roughly 423.7 million-share Tesla award shareholders approved in November 2025 had been earned as of Tesla's October 2026 proxy filing.

QUICK HIT

The controlling shareholder. Any combination with Tesla would need further approval from SpaceX's special committee, its board and "our controlling shareholder," SpaceX's 10-Q says. Tesla's 10-Q says a deal would need its committee's recommendation and any necessary shareholder approval.

Takeaways

1. Tesla and SpaceX 10-Qs both describe board committees weighing a combination.
2. Tesla fell 3.08% and SpaceX 9.14% on Thursday.
3. Musk says Tesla is making Megapacks "as much as possible."
4. He called 22 refuelings for a Moon landing "way too high."
5. Grok Bot can now use phone apps on iOS and Android.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @bot, @SpaceX, @SciGuySpace, @SawyerMerritt, @Teslaconomics, @minchoi, @nima_owji and @joehansen.

Tesla 10-Q (SEC) · SpaceX 10-Q (SEC) · SpaceX prospectus · Reuters (via Investing.com) · The Motley Fool · Bloomberg (via Yahoo Finance) · Ars Technica · NASA · Spaceflight Now · TeslaNorth · Drive · Community Impact · Moneycontrol · Photos: Wikimedia Commons (AuHaidhausen, CC BY 4.0; Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0; Ulf Klingström, public domain)

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